



Neuro-Balance Quick Training (5–7 minutes)

STEP 1 — Test First (Awareness Phase)

Goal: Identify asymmetries before you train

A. Eyes Open Balance Test

- Stand on **dominant leg** → 30 sec
- Switch to **non-dominant leg** → 30 sec

Watch for

- Foot gripping
 - Hip sway
 - Trunk lean
 - Shoulder hiking
 - Excess arm movement
-

B. Eyes Closed Balance Test

- Same sequence:
 - Dominant leg → 30 sec
 - Non-dominant leg → 30 sec

Key insight

Loss of vision immediately exposes **vestibular and proprioceptive weakness**.

Coaching cue

“Stillness first. Don’t fight the ground.”

👉 **Take note:** Which side is worse? Eyes open vs eyes closed? That tells you where the bottleneck is.

STEP 2 — Train the System (Foundational Integration)

1. Single-Leg Hart Chart Reading

Why: Vision + balance + attention

How

- Stand on one leg
- Hart chart at eye level
- Read alternating letters (top to bottom)
- Switch legs halfway

Progression

- Faster reading
- Read every other line
- **Close eyes briefly, regain stability, then continue reading**

Coaching cue

“Clear eyes, quiet body.”

2. Single-Leg VOR (Vestibulo-Ocular Reflex)

Why: Head movement while vision stays stable

How

- Stand on one leg
- Thumb at arm's length
- Eyes locked on thumb
- Rotate head side-to-side for 20–30 sec
- Switch legs

Progression

- Faster head turns
- Add vertical head motion
- **Close eyes and maintain balance without wobble**

Coaching cue

“Eyes stay locked. Head moves clean.”

3. Cossack Squat + Hart Chart Reading

Why: Dynamic balance + vision under load

How

- Wide-stance Cossack squat
- Read **one line per squat** from the Hart chart
- 5–6 reps per side

Progression

- Deeper squat
- Faster transitions

Coaching cue

“Move the body, not the eyes.”

STEP 3 — Progress Before Balance Boards

Don't rush instability tools. Earn them.

4. Peripheral Catch + Hart Chart Reading

Why: Integrates balance, peripheral vision, and reaction without chaos

How

- Athlete stands on **dominant leg first**
- Hart chart directly in front
- Partner tosses tennis balls **unpredictably** from left or right
- Athlete:
 - Keeps eyes on the chart and keeps reading
 - Catches balls using **peripheral vision only**
- Repeat on **non-dominant leg**

Coaching cue

“See wide. Stay stable.”

5. Balance Boards — Advanced Mode

- Introduced **only after**:
 - Minimal sway
 - Stable head control
 - Accurate peripheral catches

- Calm breathing

Advanced balance board progressions with Dr. Shah or team

Green Light to Advance

Move forward only when:

- Stability is maintained
- Eyes stay quiet
- No panic corrections

If the nervous system is panicking, you're training compensation—not performance.